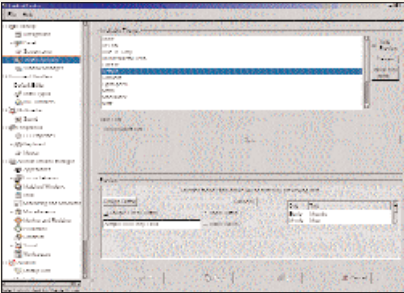


■ resolve~tips & tricks

change the look and feel of the interface, including the buttons, menus, scrollbars, etc for all the Gnome applications.



Changing the themes in Gnome

From the Theme Selector capplet, select a theme from the Available Themes. Enable auto-preview and you can see the changes live. Click on the Try button to apply the theme.

While you get a basic set of themes loaded with Gnome, there are others that you can get from <http://gtk.themes.org>. Download the theme, and then click on the Install new theme option in the capplet. Browse to the location where you downloaded the theme.

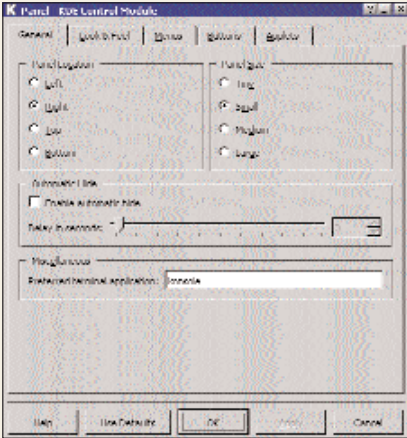
Click OK and Gnome will automatically install the theme and you can preview it from the Available Themes option.

You can also customise your fonts if you want from the themes. Just select the custom font checkbox and click on the font button. Now, you will be presented with a font selection option wherein you can specify the font, the style and size.

 Using the KDE taskbar

The taskbar is quite useful in order to keep track of all the applications that are running. The taskbar can be placed in a separate location from the KDE panel or it can be placed right there on the desktop. By default, the taskbar is located at the top of the desktop, while the panel is at the bottom.

If you want to change this, right-click on the panel, and select Settings to open the Kpanel Control Module. Choose the placement from the Panel Location



Change settings from KDE Control module

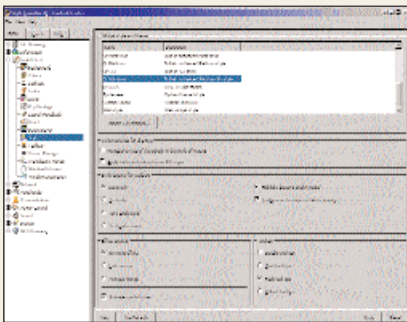
option in the General tab. You can also maximise the application currently running or bring it to the front by clicking on it in the taskbar.

 Reading the manual pages in KDE

Use [Alt] + [F2] to open the run window and type man command name (where command name is the actual command). This will open the manual pages and even unzip them on the fly if they happen to be in a compressed state. You can also use the Help Center for the same purpose. Click the Help Center icon on the toolbar, and you will see an entry called Unix manual pages in the left pane. Click on it to view all the installed manual pages in the system.

 Disabling KDE defaults for non-KDE applications

If you are running KDE as your default



Modify defaults for non-KDE applications

desktop environment, you will find that some non-KDE applications behave strangely with fonts not displaying properly at all.

You can prevent this from happening using the Look and Feel option. Click on the K icon, go to Preferences > Look and Feel > Style and from here disable the option to apply fonts and colours to your non-KDE applications.

If this does not seem to work, ensure that you click on OK directly without clicking on Apply in the same Preferences menu. If there's still a problem, then another method is to delete app-defaults directory located at /KDEDIR/share/apps/kdisplay.

What this does is prevent KDE from locating the X resource files that it needs to apply the default settings. When you exit your KDE session and everything should be back to normal.

 Using the Windows shortcuts of your keyboard

Of what use would the Windows keys on your keyboard be in Linux, you might wonder?

Well, you can configure your KDE such that even these keys come in use. For this you will have to configure your X server using xmodmap to link the key-codes for those extra keys to useful X functions.

The first step involves creating a file.Xmodmap in the home directory. Use your favourite text editor, and add the following entries:

keycode 115=F13
keycode 117=F15

(Here, we are assuming a standard keyboard mapping. To check the actual codes for your keyboard layout, use the command xev). Then type the command, xmodmap ~/.Xmodmap.

What this will do is assign [F13] to the Start key in the keyboard and [F15] to the Windows key. Now open the KDE Control Center and go to Shortcut Keys > Global Shortcut. Set the shortcut of [F13] to Pop-up system menu and that of [F15] to Windows operation menu.

Ad will come